

THE DAIMYO RETURNS

The *daimyo* is coming back from a successful hunting trip in the mountains. He rides his horse into an inner courtyard, while the castle's residents gather to watch their lord's return.

Castle gardens

Japanese castles had elaborate, carefully planted gardens with bridges, tea houses, and rare plants. They were designed to be admired from the keep as well as walked around. This garden is at Osaka Castle.



These flasks are made from wood. They are decorated with gold and layers of a hard paint called lacquer.

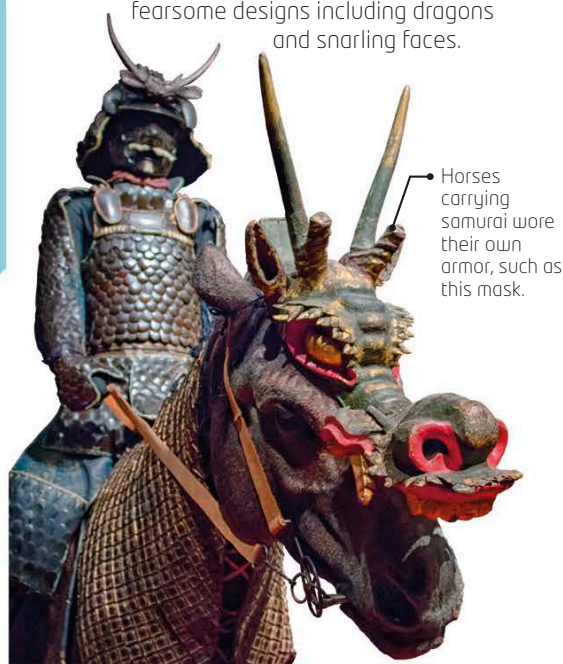


Sake flasks

These ornamental flasks contain *sake*, an alcoholic drink made from fermented rice. It was only drunk on special occasions. It was also offered to the gods at New Year and at religious festivals.

Samurai armor

The samurai were highly-trained soldiers, who learned swordsmanship and archery from a young age. They swore loyalty to their *daimyo*. Samurai armor was decorated with fearsome designs including dragons and snarling faces.



Horses carrying samurai wore their own armor, such as this mask.

Noble ladies

Japanese women were trained in many things including calligraphy, poetry, music, and dance. When the *daimyo* was away, his wife, the lady of the castle, was in charge of the fortress' defenses.



7 Masugata

This courtyard between the castle's main and second gates forms an easily defensible space.

8 Peasants

These peasants are carrying rice, which they will pay as tax to the *daimyo*.

